AMENDMENT OF SOLICITATION/MODIFICATION OF CONTRACT

BPA NO.	1. CONTRACT ID CODE	PAGE	OF	PAGES
		1		18

2. AMENDMENT/MODIFICATION NUMBER	3. EFFECTIVE DATE	4. REQUISITION/PURCHASE REQ. NUMBER	5. PROJECT NUMBER (if applicable)
0004	10-10-2026		

6. ISSUED BY	CODE	36C262	7. ADMINISTERED BY (If other than Item 6)	CODE	36C262
Department of Veterans Affairs NCO 22 - Network Contracting 3601 S. 6th Avenue Tucson AZ 85723			Department of Veterans Affairs NCO 22 - Network Contracting 3601 S. 6th Avenue Tucson AZ 85723		

8. NAME AND ADDRESS OF CONTRACTOR (Number, street, county, State and ZIP Code)	(X)	9A. AMENDMENT OF SOLICITATION NUMBER
To all Offerors/Bidders		36C26227Q0011
	X	9B. DATED (SEE ITEM 11) 09-22-2026
	☐	10A. MODIFICATION OF CONTRACT/ORDER NUMBER
		10B. DATED (SEE ITEM 13)
CODE / FACILITY CODE		

11. THIS ITEM ONLY APPLIES TO AMENDMENTS OF SOLICITATIONS

[X] The above numbered solicitation is amended as set forth in Item 14. The hour and date specified for receipt of Offers [ ] is extended, [X] is not extended.

Offers must acknowledge receipt of this amendment prior to the hour and date specified in the solicitation or as amended, by one of the following methods:

(a) By completing Items 8 and 15, and returning _____ copies of the amendment; (b) By acknowledging receipt of this amendment on each copy of the offer submitted; or (c) By separate letter or electronic communication which includes a reference to the solicitation and amendment numbers. FAILURE OF YOUR ACKNOWLEDGMENT TO BE RECEIVED AT THE PLACE DESIGNATED FOR THE RECEIPT OF OFFERS PRIOR TO THE HOUR AND DATE SPECIFIED MAY RESULT IN REJECTION OF YOUR OFFER. If by virtue of this amendment you desire to change an offer already submitted, such change may be made by letter or electronic communication, provided each letter or electronic communication makes reference to the solicitation and this amendment, and is received prior to the opening hour and date specified.

12. ACCOUNTING AND APPROPRIATION DATA (If required)

13. THIS ITEM APPLIES ONLY TO MODIFICATIONS OF CONTRACTS/ORDERS, IT MODIFIES THE CONTRACT/ORDER NO. AS DESCRIBED IN ITEM 14.

CHECK ONE	
☐	A. THIS CHANGE ORDER IS ISSUED PURSUANT TO: (Specify authority) THE CHANGES SET FORTH IN ITEM 14 ARE MADE IN THE CONTRACT ORDER NO. IN ITEM 10A.
☐	B. THE ABOVE NUMBERED CONTRACT/ORDER IS MODIFIED TO REFLECT THE ADMINISTRATIVE CHANGES (such as changes in paying office, appropriation date, etc.) SET FORTH IN ITEM 14, PURSUANT TO THE AUTHORITY OF FAR 43.103(b).
☐	C. THIS SUPPLEMENTAL AGREEMENT IS ENTERED INTO PURSUANT TO AUTHORITY OF:
☐	D. OTHER (Specify type of modification and authority)

E. IMPORTANT: Contractor [ ] is not, [X] is required to sign this document and return 1 copies to the issuing office.

14. DESCRIPTION OF AMENDMENT/MODIFICATION (Organized by UCF section headings, including solicitation/contract subject matter where feasible.)

1. The purpose of this amendment is to respond to the questions asked related to this solicitation on pages 2-18 of this amendment.

No further questions will be answered.

Except as provided herein, all terms and conditions of the document referenced in Item 9A or 10A, as heretofore changed, remains unchanged and in full force and effect.

15A. NAME AND TITLE OF SIGNER (Type or print)		16A. NAME AND TITLE OF CONTRACTING OFFICER (Type or print)	
		Mayte Diaz Contracting Officer	
15B. CONTRACTOR/OFFEROR (Signature of person authorized to sign)	15C. DATE SIGNED	16B. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA (Signature of Contracting Officer)	16C. DATE SIGNED

Q: Is there any incumbent/recompete or this is a brand-new project? If yes, could you please provide us with their award number or even if the customer bought similar services in the past.

A: Previous incumbent was Mission Linen Supply, Contract 36C25822C0011.

Q: Is the contractor supposed to provide the linen items (Lab coats, fitted sheets ect) or just launder them?

A: Launder and provide.

Q: Has the scope of work materially changed from the incumbent/predecessor requirement? If so, please identify the major changes in workload, linen inventory, service frequency, delivery requirements, reporting, or performance standards.

A: No changes, scope of work will sustain what's in the contract.

Q: The SOW estimates approximately 1,350,000 pounds of soiled linen and 1,255,500 pounds of clean linen annually. Are these estimates based on actual recent SAVAHCS usage, and can the Government provide the most recent 12 months of actual monthly poundage?

A: Yes, to both questions.

Q: For the four-hour emergency linen shortage requirement, does the four-hour period apply 24 hours per day/7 days per week, including weekends and federal holidays, or only during specified operating/service hours?

A: 24 hours per day/7 days per week, including weekends and federal holidays.

Q: What is the established routine pickup and delivery schedule—days per week, delivery windows, and number of scheduled stops per day/week? The QASP requires compliance with the established pickup/delivery schedule, but the specific schedule is important for transportation pricing.

A: One pick-up point, 5 days per week and prepare PAR delivery a day early. Between 6:00AM-8:00AM and no later than 12:30pm in the afternoon.

Q: Is there a maximum allowable distance between the contractor's Textile Care Processing Facility and SAVAHCS, particularly considering the four-hour emergency response requirement?

A: The window will be two hours not four hours.

Q: Does the Government require a specific healthcare laundry accreditation or certification, such as HLAC, TRSA Healthcare certification, or another third-party accreditation, or is demonstrated compliance with the standards and VHA directives contained in the SOW sufficient?

A: The Government prefers third party verification to ensure compliance with infection prevention and patient safety requirements.

Q: Regarding contractor-furnished rental linen, are the listed dimensions, materials, thread counts, colors, and other specifications considered exact requirements, or will commercially equivalent items be accepted? The SOW indicates equivalent or similar contractor-provided linen within industry standards may be offered for COR review.

A: Equivalent or similar contractor-provided linen within industry standards may be offered.

Q: For Government-furnished specialty items, uniforms, mental-health pillows/blankets, and other non-rental items, can the Government provide the approximate historical monthly quantities or poundage processed?

A: The Government will not share this information.

Q: Will the Government provide sufficient on-site storage space for the required 96-hour contingency linen inventory, carts, and associated materials, or is the contractor responsible for furnishing storage equipment or containers?

A: The Government will not provide on-site storage space, must be held off-site at the contractor's plant/warehouse.

Q: Will subcontracting of the laundry processing, linen rental, and/or transportation functions be permitted, provided the prime contractor remains responsible for overall contract performance and all solicitation requirements?

A: Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: Is a site visit available for prospective offerors and/or their proposed laundry subcontractors to inspect the receiving/loading areas, linen storage areas, delivery routes, and operational environment before quotations are due?

A: Site visit was scheduled for October 06, 2026 at 09:00am as stated on amendment 0002..

Q: Will the Government provide historical information regarding average rewash/reject rates, emergency deliveries, linen shortages, and service discrepancies under the incumbent contract?

A: The Government will not share this information.

Q: For Government Furnished Items, would it be possible at all to substitute with our rental items during the performance of this contract?

A: Only if items are made in America and the company is American based and registered as such.

Q: SOW 1.3.7 and 5.1.8 say about 1,350,000 lbs soiled per year. Technical Exhibit 3's grand yearly total is 1,280,467.2 lbs, and its line items actually add up to about 1,338,748 lbs. Which figure should offerors use for pricing?

A: Approximately1,350,000 pounds of soiled linen annually.

Q: For 18" microfiber mops, the par level table (5.1.10) shows 8,000/week and 36,000/month, but Technical Exhibit 3 shows 3,750/week and 16,875/month. Which is correct?

A: 36,000.

Q: Chef coats and mamo capes appear in the par level table but not in Technical Exhibit 3. What weights and usage should we assume for them?

A: Industry standard.

Q: Are there historical monthly soiled/clean poundage figures from the last 12 months?

A: Approximately1,350,000 pounds of soiled linen annually and 1,255,500 pounds of clean linen.

Q: Is the contractor expected to supply a full new rental inventory at start-up? Can current (incumbent-owned) linen stay in circulation during phase-in?

A: Supply a full new rental inventory at start-up.

Q: SOW §1.1 calls for a contractor-owned/contractor-operated plant and pickup/delivery by contractor personnel. May a small-business prime subcontract all physical plant processing, linen supply and pickup/delivery to a named, first-tier similarly situated small-business healthcare laundry, while the prime directly manages the contract, quality control, scheduling and invoicing? If so, may that partner own/operate the plant and provide the VA-badged drivers, subject to the prime's FAR 52.219-14 and VA 852.219-75 obligations?

A: Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting. VA 852.219-75 does not apply to this solicitation, set-aside is for a Small Business.

Q: Amendment 0001 says SP2 Subcontractor Compliance is deleted in full from E.1 and E.3, yet the replacement pages still print SP2. Does SP2 apply to offers under the amended RFQ, and should an offeror propose the partner/work allocation described there?

A: Amendment 0001 has a strikethrough line on SP2 on section E.1 and E.3 meaning, SP2 is removed in its entirety.

Q: Amendment 0001 changes CLIN 0001's base period to nine months (January–September 2027), while the SOW workload estimate is stated per year. Should offerors use nine-twelfths of the annual estimated pounds for base-period planning, or will the VA issue a separate nine-month estimate? Please identify the binding pricing basis.

A: Offerors should use 9 months for the base year and 12 months for Option Years 1, 2, 3 and 4.

Q: Could you please provide the Planholders List, Pre-Bid Attendance Sheet, or any registered Interested Vendors list for this solicitation so we may offer our transport capabilities to prospective bidding partners?

A: The Government will not share this information.

Q: I see that the SAVAHCS Linen and Laundry Services requirement has been reposted; however, the requirements appear to remain mostly unchanged. Can you provide any insight into what prompted the reposting?

A: Prior Solicitation 36C26227Q0001 was cancelled due to changes needed on IGCE.

Q: Would you be open to considering an out of state facility, also within VISN 22, as an alternative location for processing the SAVAHCS linen? Under this approach, we would coordinate the transportation, pickup, and delivery between Tucson and out of state, while the linen would be processed at the out of State facility.

A: No.

Q: Can you clarify if the current solicitation (36C26227Q0011) should be listed as full and open or if the current Small Business Set-Aside is accurate?

A: Solicitation 36C26227Q0011 is set- aside for Small Business only as stated on the Solicitation.

Q: It reads like the new RFP is also a small business set aside?

A: Correct, Solicitation 36C26227Q0011 is set- aside for Small Business only.

Q: When we ran the math on the individual line items, we found that some of the totals don't appear to add up to the totals shown in the exhibit. For example, in Section 5.1.1, the

monthly weights shown are 5,118.75 lbs for pillowcases, 11,287.50 lbs for flat sheets, and 937.50 lbs for surgical towels. Those add up to 17,343.75 lbs, but the section total currently shows 12,225 lbs. We also found that when we calculate the individual line items throughout Exhibit 3, the resulting annual total does not match the currently shown Grand Yearly Total. Since these numbers will affect both our processing price and the amount of linen we need to plan for, would you mind taking a look at it? If you agree there is a math issue, would it make sense to issue a corrected Technical Exhibit 3 by amendment so everyone is pricing from the same numbers?

A: The Technical Exhibit 3 has been used prior with no errors found.

Q: May a small-business prime contractor satisfy the off-site laundry processing, pickup/delivery, and related operational requirements through a first-tier subcontractor that is itself a small business under NAICS 812320, while the prime remains responsible for contract management, quality control, invoicing, and overall contract performance?

A: Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: Where the solicitation refers to a "contractor owned/contractor operated" laundry facility, must that facility be owned and operated directly by the prime offeror, or may it be owned and operated by the prime's first-tier subcontractor?

A: Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: For the active Business License requirement identified as SP1, must the prime offeror itself hold a laundry-specific business license, or would the applicable license(s) held by the subcontractor actually operating the laundry facility satisfy that requirement? If both entities must provide licensing documentation, please confirm.

A: Prime Contractor and all subcontractor(s) shall provide an active Business License.

Q: SOW 5.1.10 references required weekly/monthly par-level quantities, and the SOW also requires a separate 96-hour contingency supply. The current SAM.gov posting shows four attachments, but we do not see a separate itemized linen/par-level inventory. Please confirm the itemized par-level quantities applicable to this solicitation, or provide the current inventory schedule if it is intended to be a separate attachment.

A: 96-hour contingency supply is not separated, it's always on stand by at contractor's facility and is rotated out every 90 days. Copy of Itemized Linen Inventory for 96 hour contingency supply provided as an attachment on this amendment.

Q: SOW 5.1.8 identifies approximately 1,255,500 clean pounds and 1,350,000 soiled pounds annually, while the amended base period is January 1, 2027 through September 30, 2027 (9 months). Please confirm whether those poundage estimates are annualized run-rate figures,

with base-period volume expected to reflect approximately nine months of that annual run rate absent changes in actual demand.

A: Poundage estimates are annualized run-rate figures for 12 months.

Q: The base performance period is stated as January 1 through September 30, 2027, but the pricing schedule appears to show a quantity of seven months for CLIN 0001. Should offerors price seven months or the full nine-month period?

A: Please see amendment 0001 with updated Price/Cost Schedule.

Q: Should the estimated annual workload of approximately 1,350,000 pounds of soiled linen be prorated for the base period?

A: Yes.

Q: Please confirm the expected pickup and delivery frequency and whether the Government owns and supplies the linen inventory.

A: One pick-up point, 5 days per week and prepare PAR delivery a day early. The Government does not own and does not supply the linen inventory.

Q: Please confirm the applicable limitation on subcontracting and whether work performed by a similarly situated small-business commercial laundry would count toward compliance.

A: Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: The solicitation requires an active Business License under SP1. For an offeror organized and licensed in Texas, does this requirement mean the offeror must also hold an Arizona or City of Tucson business license at the time of quotation submission, or may any required Arizona/local registration be completed before award/performance?

A: The offeror may satisfy SP1 with an active Business License from any State in the United States.

Q: Because this is a 100% small-business set-aside, may a small-business prime use one or more subcontractors that also qualify as small under NAICS 812320 to perform portions of the work, subject to FAR 52.219-14 and the solicitation's Limitations on Subcontracting certification?

A: Yes. Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: Section B.2 requests a unit price using the unit of measure MO, while SOW Section 5.1.8 provides estimated annual processing volumes of approximately 1,350,000 soiled

pounds and 1,255,500 clean pounds. Please clarify whether CLIN 0001 is to be priced and invoiced as a fixed monthly amount. Example: The unit for the clin is Monthly so for each Month does the contractor bill for 104,625 clean pounds.

A: You will bill for the volume received not a fix amount.

Q: If the government exceeds the estimated 1,350,000 soiled pounds and 1,255,500 clean pounds will there be an equitable adjustment allowed?

A: Yes, these are only estimates.

Q: Can the government provide the last twelve months of historical quantities of processed weight? Either a POP or chronological.

A: Approximately1,350,000 pounds of soiled linen annually and 1,255,500 pounds of clean linen.

Q: SOW Section 4.2.1 requires the Contractor to furnish the linen inventory, including a separate 96-hour contingency supply. Please identify the required operating PAR level or quantity of Contractor-furnished linen that must be maintained in addition to the 96-hour contingency inventory.

A: Off Site Reserve will be 96-hour contingency linen, Par level will reflect 50% of the weekly usage quantity.

Q: Linen Loss report page 50 – and PARA 5.6.1 provides for tracking and a contractor reimbursement path for linen Loss. At what price are the tracked lost linens reimbursed or replaced. Is there a Clin for this or how will it funded and invoiced?

A: 2% over cost.

Q: Section B.2 includes a Miscellaneous Service (as needed) CLIN for each contract period. Please define the services intended to be covered by these CLINs and clarify the amount or pricing methodology offerors are to enter for each Miscellaneous Service CLIN.

A: Miscellaneous Services are intended for services not included in the SOW such as emergency services.

Q: Part 5 identifies microfiber mops and other specialty items requiring processing. Please clarify whether all items listed in Part 5 are included within the pound-based estimated processing volume in Section 5.1.8 or whether any items will be tracked and invoiced on a per-piece or other unit basis. If items are to be priced separately, please provide the applicable unit of measure and estimated quantities.

A: On a per piece basis.

Q: SOW Section 5.1.9 identifies Government-owned Mental Health pillows and blankets requiring specialized processing and estimates approximately 15 sets per week. Please confirm whether processing these items is included within the Section 5.1.8 estimated annual poundage and CLIN 0001 price, or whether they are to be separately priced.

A: Priced separately.

Q: We noticed a difference in the estimated usage quantities provided for the 18-inch microfiber mops. Section 5.1.10 on page 48 identifies estimated usage of 8,000 pieces per week / 36,000 pieces per month, while Technical Exhibit 3 identifies estimated usage of 3,750 pieces per week / 16,875 pieces per month. S02+36C26227Q0011-Since this difference affects both the anticipated processing volume and the quantity of contractor-furnished rental inventory required, would the Government please clarify which quantity should be used for pricing and inventory planning?

A: 36,000.

Q: Additionally, should the processing weights associated with the correct 18-inch microfiber mop quantity be included in the total estimated workload stated in Section 5.1.8?

A: Tracked under a separate piece-rate standard.

Q: Amendment 0001 states that SP2 is removed from E.1 and E.3, but its continuation pages still reproduce SP2. Should offerors treat SP2 as deleted?

A: Amendment 0001 has a strikethrough line on SP2 on section E.1 and E.3 meaning, SP2 is removed in its entirety.

Q: What subcontractor identification or work-allocation information remains required at submission?

A: Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: Could you identify the location of, or provide, the required VAAR 852.219-75 signed certificate of compliance and confirm the applicable subcontracting limitations for this total small-business set-aside?

A: VA 852.219-75 does not apply to this solicitation, set-aside is for a Small Business.

Q: For SP1, which active business license must the prime provide, and are any Arizona/Tucson licenses or processing-facility licenses required from a proposed laundry subcontractor?

A: The offeror may satisfy SP1 with an active Business License from any State in the United States. If the offeror intends to use a subcontractor(s), the offeror must provide the subcontractor(s) business license.

Q: Please confirm that October 12, 2026, at 3:00 p.m. MDT (Denver time), as shown in SF 1449 Block 8, remains the offer deadline.

A: Correct, unless an extension is granted which would be posted as an amendment to SAM to this solicitation.

Q: The solicitation includes FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting, and Amendment 0001 removes the Special Standard of Responsibility SP2 – Subcontractor Compliance.

A: VA 852.219-75 does not apply to this solicitation therefore, SP2 is not needed. FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting does apply to this solicitation therefore Prime contractor must adhere.

Q: Would (contractor name), as the small-business prime contractor, be permitted to use a first-tier subcontractor that is also a qualifying small business under NAICS 812320 to perform the laundry plant operations, linen rental/inventory, transportation, and related field services, while (contractor name) remains responsible for contract administration, oversight, invoicing, reporting, and overall performance?

A: Yes, as long as the prime contractor is adhering to FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: Relatedly, the Statement of Work refers to "contractor owned/contractor operated" bulk laundry/linen services and an off-site laundry plant. Does that language require the prime contractor itself to own and operate the laundry plant and linen inventory, or may those requirements be satisfied by an approved first-tier subcontractor performing under the prime?

A: This may be satisfied by a subcontractor as long as the prime contractor is adhering to FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: The solicitation requires the offeror to provide an "active Business License." Could you please clarify whether this means the prime contractor's current business registration/license in its state of formation, or whether the prime must hold an Arizona, Tucson, or other local business license at the time of offer submission?

A: The offeror may satisfy SP1 with an active Business License from any State in the United States. If the offeror intends to use a subcontractor(s), the offeror must provide the subcontractor(s) business license.

Q: Is this indeed a small business set aside?

A: Yes.

Q: If it is a small business set aside, can you explain why it's been moved from an open solicitation (i.e. for everyone to bid on regardless of size) to a small business set aside? Just wanting to make sure that this wasn't categorized as a set aside by accident.

A: Requirement is set-aside for Small Business only as stated on the Solicitation, page 1, section 10.

Q: Can you clarify if this is a rental and wash requirement or does the VA own their own linens and they are only in need of laundering services?

A: Yes.

Q: Will any pre award plant survey be conducted at the proposed subcontractor's processing facility?

A: Yes.

Q: Please confirm that the offer deadline is October 12, 2026, at 3:00 p.m. Mountain Daylight Time, equivalent to 2:00 p.m. in Tucson and Los Angeles.

A: Yes.

Q: Pricing / invoicing structure: Section B prices the recurring laundry service by month, while the SOW invoice example references per-pound and per-piece quantities/rates. Please confirm whether offerors are evaluated and paid on the monthly FFP amounts in Section B, and whether a separate per-pound/per-piece rate schedule is required with the offer.

A: A separate per-pound/per-piece rate schedule is required with the offer and paid monthly.

Q: The SOW requires a 96-hour contingency linen supply to be maintained at the facility. Please provide the linen types and quantities the VA expects to comprise that 96-hour inventory, or confirm the basis offerors should use to size and price it.

A: Copy of Itemized Linen Inventory for 96 hour contingency supply provided as an attachment on this amendment.

Q: Healthcare accreditation: The SOW references healthcare accreditation requirements. Please confirm the specific accreditation/certification standard, if any, that the processing facility must hold at the time of offer or performance.

A: HLAC.

Q: Would the VA permit a small-business prime contractor to perform contract administration, compliance oversight, invoicing, and subcontractor management while a

qualified small-business laundry subcontractor performs the physical laundry processing, pickup, and delivery services, provided the arrangement complies with FAR 52.219-14 and VAAR 852.219-75?

A: Prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting. VA 852.219-75 does not apply to this solicitation, set-aside is for a Small Business.

Q: Section 5.1.10 lists 36,000 18-inch microfiber mops per month; Exhibit 3 lists 16,875. Which quantity controls?

A: 36,000.

Q: The narrative lists 1,255,500 annual clean pounds versus 1,280,467.2 in Exhibit 3. Please confirm the controlling workload and how changes affect the fixed monthly service price.

A: It varies; we can't make that determination. Too many variables.

Q: Please reconcile the monthly service CLINs with the per-pound/per-piece sample invoice and miscellaneous EA items. We are treating the sample rates as examples, not incumbent pricing.

A: The Government is unable to make this change.

Q: Please identify the required item mix/quantities for the 96-hour reserve, and how the 90-day transition language aligns with full performance at the January 1 start.

A: The contractor who bids on this requirement must know the essential items needed for a contingency plan at a hospital.

Q: Please confirm holiday and after-hours four-hour shortage-delivery coverage, and whether one vehicle may transport clean and soiled loads sequentially after the required sanitation, provided they are never carried together.

A: One vehicle is fine as long as you follow proper protocol to Include a two-hour window NOT FOUR.

Q: We plan to partner with a qualified, certified laundry processing facility as our subcontractor to handle the washing, while we manage the complete pickup, delivery, and transportation logistics. As the prime contractor, are we permitted to submit a single consolidated pricing schedule that includes our subcontractor's processing services?

A: Yes.

Q: What specific documentation, letters of commitment, or compliance forms must be submitted with our proposal package regarding our laundry subcontractor?

A: SP1: Business License for both the Prime and subcontractor(s).

Q: Would a direct laundry subcontractor that qualifies as a small business under the appropriate subcontract NAICS code be considered a "similarly situated entity," or must it also be a certified SDVOSB or VOSB?

A: The prime contractor who is submitting offer must adhere to FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: Which limitations-on-subcontracting requirements apply to this acquisition? Please provide the complete applicable clause text and required certification form.

A: FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: The solicitation identifies this acquisition as a total small-business set-aside and references FAR 52.219-14 (Deviation November 2025). However, Section E.1 also requires a signed certification under VAAR 852.219-75.

A: Requirement is set-aside for Small Business only as stated on the Solicitation, page 1, section 10. VA 852.219-75 does not apply to this solicitation

Q: May the prime contractor use a qualifying, similarly situated laundry subcontractor to perform the laundry processing and delivery services while the prime manages contract administration, quality oversight, and customer coordination?

A: Yes, prime contractor must adhere to FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting.

Q: What payment amounts or cost categories are included in the subcontracting-limit calculation, and are any exclusions applicable to linen rental, supplies, or transportation?

A: Please refer to FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting.

(e) Limitations on subcontracting. By submission of an offer and execution of a contract, the Contractor agrees that in performance of a contract assigned a North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code for—

(1) Services (except construction), it will not pay more than 50 percent of the amount paid by the Government for contract performance to subcontractors that are not similarly situated entities. Any work that a similarly situated entity further subcontracts will count towards the prime contractor's 50 percent subcontract amount that cannot be exceeded. When a contract includes both services and supplies, the 50 percent limitation shall apply only to the service portion of the contract;

Q: Is compliance measured over the base period and each option period separately, or on another basis?

A: Compliance is measured strictly by VHA directive 1850.03.

Q: Please confirm that Amendment 0001's deletion of SP2 applies despite SP2 remaining in the reproduced instructions, and whether the deletion affects only submission documentation or any substantive subcontracting requirement.

A: Amendment 0001 has a strikethrough line on SP2 on section E.1 and E.3 meaning, SP2 is removed in its entirety.

Q: Will an active state of Arizona or home-jurisdiction business license satisfy SP1, or is a City of Tucson business license required? If a license application is pending at the response date, will proof of application be accepted?

A: The offeror may satisfy SP1 with an active Business License from any State in the United States. If the offeror intends to use a subcontractor(s), the offeror must provide the subcontractor(s) business license.

Q: Section B prices CLINs x001 as monthly (MO) lump sums, while SOW 5.6.2 requires monthly invoices reconciled by CLIN and service category per pound or piece. Must offerors submit unit prices per pound/piece by service category with the quotation? Is the monthly amount fixed, or will it vary with actual pounds/pieces processed?

A: It is a varied amount. Offerors to submit prices per pound/piece.

Q: Please describe the scope of the "Miscellaneous Service (as needed)" CLINs and provide an estimated quantity or not-to-exceed amount so that all offerors price these CLINs on the same basis for evaluation.

A: Miscellaneous Services are intended for services not included in the SOW such as emergency services.

Q: The solicitation states three different annual volumes: approximately 1,350,000 lbs soiled and 1,255,500 lbs clean (5.1.8), and 1,280,467 lbs (Technical Exhibit 3). Which volume should offerors use for pricing? Will invoicing be based on soiled weight or clean weight, and where will weighing occur?

A: 1,350,000 pounds of soiled linen annually.

Q: For contractor-owned rental linen, how will losses be valued and reimbursed after the 120-day period (e.g., at a replacement price stated in the quotation)? Should offerors include a linen replacement price schedule?

A: Yes, a linen replacement price schedule.

Q: Please provide the average monthly soiled pounds received from SAVAHCS for the most recent 12 months.

A: Approximately 1,350,000 pounds of soiled linen.

Q: Please provide the average monthly clean pounds and pieces delivered to SAVAHCS for the most recent 12 months.

A: Approximately 1,255,500 pounds of clean linen.

Q: Is any linen, cart or Z-rack inventory currently in circulation Government-owned, and will any of it remain available to the new contractor? Will the Government facilitate inventory exchange with the current contractor during the phase-in period?

A: Contractor must supply a full new rental inventory at start-up.

Q: Given the 01/01/2027 start date, what is the anticipated award date, and when may the contractor begin phase-in activities (badging, delivery of initial linen inventory and contingency supply)?

A: Anticipated award date can range from days, weeks or months leading up to the award date. This all depends if delays that may arise.

Q: Please confirm the contractor's responsibility for clean delivery and soiled pickup ends at the designated loading docks (Building 16 clean dock; Coast Guard Ave. soiled dock), and that VA staff transport carts between the docks and patient care areas.

A: Confirmed.

Q: Are there vehicle size, height or weight restrictions at either dock?

A: Average dock dimensions for 24-foot box truck.

Q: Will the separate 96-hour contingency linen supply be stored at the area walked on 9/6 aka Linen Storage Room? Or is there a 3rd drop location separate from storage room location and soiled dock location?

A: The Government will not provide on-site storage space, must be held off-site at the contractor's plant/warehouse.

Q: For Government-furnished cubicle curtains and uniforms, will VA staff remove, bag and rehang curtains and deliver uniforms to the soiled dock, or must the contractor pick up from individual departments? If pickup is required at cubicle locations, please provide a description of the task for time evaluation by contractor.

A: VA Staff will assist with that task.

Q: Does the four-hour linen shortage and emergency response requirement apply only during the hours in SOW 1.9 (6:30 AM – 4:30 PM, Monday – Friday), or also on evenings, weekends and Federal holidays?

A: 24 hours per day/7 days per week, including weekends and federal holidays.

Q: The Mental Health special handling instructions state that 130-lb Girbau washers and dryers are "preferred." Please confirm that equivalent commercial equipment meeting the stated wash and dry parameters is acceptable.

A: The equivalent may be preferred if the specs meet Girbau standards, if not contractor will be liable.

Q: Will current accreditation by the Healthcare Laundry Accreditation Council (HLAC) or TRSA Hygienically Clean Healthcare be accepted as evidence that the processing facility meets the Joint Commission and ALM standards referenced in the SOW?

A: Yes.

Q: Are there VA information-security or system-interface requirements for the contractor's electronic or online linen ordering program (for example, VA network access, data hosting, or an Authority to Operate)?

A: No.

Q: The risk and sensitivity table in C.8 does not indicate which tier applies. What background investigation tier and identification (PIV or local facility badge) will be required for contractor drivers and personnel accessing the loading docks?

A: General contractor access requirements only.

Q: For purposes of the limitations on subcontracting, will the cost of contractor-furnished rental linen inventory be treated as "cost of materials" excluded from the calculation under 13 CFR 125.6?

A: No.

Q: Section E.1 requires offerors to complete and return the VAAR 852.219-75 certificate, stating that failure to do so will preclude consideration. By its terms, 852.219-75 implements 38 U.S.C. 8127 and measures the limitation against VIP-listed SDVOSBs and VOSBs, which applies to VA veteran-owned set-asides. This solicitation is a total small business set-aside under FAR 52.219-6, with limitations on subcontracting governed by FAR 52.219-14. Please confirm: (a) whether 852.219-75 applies to this acquisition; (b) if it does, that "similarly situated entity" for this acquisition means a small business concern under NAICS 812320, as defined in FAR 52.219-14 and 13 CFR 125.1, rather than a VIP-

listed SDVOSB or VOSB; and (c) if it does not apply, that the certificate is not required and its omission will not preclude consideration for award.

A: Requirement is set-aside for Small Business only as stated on the Solicitation, page 1, section 10. VA 852.219-75 does not apply to this solicitation

Q: Will the Government provide the linens and other items to be processed, or is the contractor expected to provide the linens?

A: Contractor must supply a full new rental inventory at start-up.

Q: Was attendance at the October 6, 2026 site visit required as a condition of submitting an offer, or may an offeror that did not attend still submit an offer?

A: No.

Q: Does the VA require only the monthly CLIN prices in Section B, or should offerors also submit an additional per-pound /per-piece rate schedule?

A: Additional per-pound/per-piece rate.

Q: Can you please confirm whether this requires a current municipal/county Business Tax Receipt, or whether an active Florida business registration such as Sunbiz would satisfy the requirement? If a local Business Tax Receipt is specifically required, please confirm whether it must be active at the time of proposal submission.

A: Yes, to both questions.

Q: Given that the incumbent provider and several organizations participating in the site visit are large businesses, I was hoping to gain a better understanding around the small business set-aside determination.

A: Requirement is set-aside for Small Business only as stated on the Solicitation, page 1, section 10.

Q: Will the FAR 52.217-8 six-month extension be included in price evaluation?

A: No.

Q: Amendment 0001 states that Special Standard of Responsibility SP2 (Subcontractor Compliance) is removed, but the reprinted E.1 and E.3 still include SP2. Please confirm whether SP2 information is required in File #2.

A: No.

Q: SOW 5.6.2 states "Sample invoice required." Should a sample invoice be included with the offer, or is it a post-award requirement?

A: No.

NOTE: Any questions not answered is due to it not having any relevancy to the current solicitation and or is public information in which a contractor may request a FOIA.